

APPLE SDE INTERN EXPERIENCE

ABOUT THE COMPANY:

Apple Inc. is a global leader in technology and innovation, best known for designing, manufacturing, and selling consumer electronics, computer software, and online services. Apple is widely recognized for its premium hardware products, seamless software ecosystem, and strong focus on user experience, privacy, and design.

JOB DESCRIPTION:

“We are looking for remarkable individuals with excellent communication abilities and strong interpersonal skills, who can collaborate effectively across diverse business and technical teams. The ideal candidate is a proactive, motivated individual with outstanding interpersonal skills and a flexible, positive attitude toward problem-solving. “

ROLE OFFERED: SDE Intern (Software Development Engineering Intern)

MONTHLY INTERNSHIP STIPEND: 105,000 INR

SELECTION PROCESS:

1. Online Assessment
2. Technical Interview(R1)
3. Techno Managerial Interview(R2)

ONLINE ASSESSMENT:

The Online Assessment was conducted in CoderPad with a duration of 1 hour and 30 minutes. The session was split into two parts:

- 1)Multiple Choice Questions(10)
- 2)Coding Questions (2)

MCQs were mainly on OOPS(SOLID Principle, abstract class property),OS(LRU page fault identification),CN(Bandwidth delay product calc ,TCP Congestion control),DSA(time complexity ,algorithms)

Coding Question 1:

Restaurant Queue Management: Calculate the total profit of a restaurant with limited seats, where guests arrive and leave according to a log, pay only once, wait in a FIFO queue if seats are full, and leave if they lose patience.

Eg:

n = 3

price = [6, 2, 9, 5, 8] logs = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 0, 3, 2, 4]

Explanation:

- $n = 3$: 3 seats available.
- $\text{price}[i]$: Guest 0 $\rightarrow$ ₹6, Guest 1 logs sequence:
- 0 arrives $\rightarrow$ seat available $\rightarrow$ seated
- 1 arrives $\rightarrow$ seat available $\rightarrow$ seated
- 2 arrives $\rightarrow$ seat available $\rightarrow$ seated
- 3 arrives $\rightarrow$ all seats full $\rightarrow$ waits
- 4 arrives $\rightarrow$ all seats full $\rightarrow$ waits
- 1 leaves $\rightarrow$ seat free $\rightarrow$ 3 seated
- 0 leaves $\rightarrow$ seat free $\rightarrow$ 4 seated
- 3 leaves $\rightarrow$ seat free
- 2 leaves $\rightarrow$ seat free
- 4 leaves $\rightarrow$ seat free
- **Seated Guests:** 0, 1, 2, 3, 4 $\rightarrow$ all paid once.
- **Profit:**
 $6 + 2 + 9 + 5 + 8 = 30$

Coding Question 2:

The task is to write a program that determines and returns the current state of a tennis game based on the points scored by two players.

Tennis Scoring Rules Recap:

- A tennis game is scored in points:
 - 1st point $\rightarrow$ 15
 - 2nd point $\rightarrow$ 30
 - 3rd point $\rightarrow$ 40
- After both players reach at least 40 points, three special conditions apply:
 1. Deuce:
 - When both players have scored the same number of points (and at least 3 points each).
 - Example: 5–5.
 2. Advantage:
 - When both have at least 3 points, but one player has 1 point more than the other.
 - Example: 6–5 (Advantage Player 1) or 5–6 (Advantage Player 2).

3. Win:

- A player wins if they have at least 4 points and at least 2 points more than the opponent.
- Example: 8–4 → Player 1 wins.

Example:

nameP1 = "Alice"

nameP2 = "Bob"

winner = {"Alice", "Bob", "Alice", "Alice"}

Alice scores: 3 points (15 → 30 → 40) Bob scores: 1 point (15)

Output: "40 - 15"

{If more points are played and it becomes 4–4:

Output: "Deuce"

If it becomes 5–4:

Output: "Advantage Alice"

If it becomes 6–4:

Output: "Alice wins"}

➔ Even though the **tennis game rules look lengthy**, the implementation logic is actually very simple. The whole problem boils down to a few clear **if–else conditions** based on the scores of the two players.

TECHNICAL INTERVIEW ROUND 1 (45 mins):

The technical interview was conducted virtually. Initially, the interviewer asked me to introduce myself, followed by a few questions about my projects — particularly focusing on the unique contributions I had made to them. After that, the session moved to a **pair coding round**. The problem given was the "[Restrictive Candy Crush](#)" problem GFG. The interviewer clearly explained the problem statement and asked me to first describe my approach with a **dry run** of the test cases.

I explained the **stack-based approach**, where each number and its count are stored and updated as we process the input. She then asked me to write the **pseudocode** and explain it step-by-step, followed by an analysis of the **time and space complexity**. She also asked me to suggest the **possible test cases** that could be designed for this problem to ensure correctness and handle edge scenarios. This part of the interview focused more on how **interactively** I was solving the problem and thinking through different situations. The interviewer was satisfied with my approach and explanation.

Next, the discussion shifted to concepts related to **Locks and Semaphores**. I was asked to explain **read-write locks**, **two-phase locking** (with an example), and provide an **overview of locks, semaphores, and concurrency**. I explained each concept with suitable examples, and the interviewer was satisfied.

TECHNO MANAGERIAL INTERVIEW (R2):

The interview began with a self-introduction, where I briefly talked about my background and interests. This was followed by a discussion of my projects, where I explained few projects and the reason for choosing the particular tech stack. The interviewer also asked for my opinion on Python versus Java and why I prefer one over the other, and asked me to list out the cases where Python can be preferred and then about which tech stacks I am familiar with and my level of experience with each and about the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) and its different phases in the design process. This was followed by, behavioral and Situational Questions:

1. **Conflict Management:** *"How would you manage a conflict between your teammates?"*
2. **Tech Stack Issue Midway:** *"You realize halfway through the deadline that the chosen tech stack won't work. What will you do?"*
3. **New Technology with Limited Time:** *"If you are given a new tech stack you're not familiar with and have only 2 days to complete the work while your teammates are busy, what will you do?"*
4. **Team Preference:** *"Do you prefer working alone, in a team of two, or in a larger team?"*

The interviewer then returned to discussing my project work and asked how long it took me to adapt to a new skill, how I managed the learning process, and how I prioritized my tasks during the project. I utilized the last 10 minutes of the interview to ask the interviewer about Apple's work culture and his journey of getting into Apple, which helped me gain valuable insights and left a positive impression. The interview lasted around 45 minutes.

[The online assessment was conducted on 4th September, and the results were announced on the same day. My first interview round was held on 23rd September, followed by the second round on 24th September. This gave me around 20 days to prepare effectively.]

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

1. **Give a strong and impressive self-introduction** – it's the most important part of the interview as it reflects who you are and sets the tone for the rest of the discussion.
2. **Know your project work thoroughly** – interviewers are highly experienced, so you must be confident and well-prepared to discuss your contributions, challenges faced, and solutions implemented.
3. **Practice coding consistently** on platforms like LeetCode and GFG, and focus deeply on **Operating Systems, DBMS, OOPs, Computer Networks, and System Design** – not just theoretically but also with **practical applications**, as interviewers often expect real-world examples.

Pitch yourself effectively – most of the questions will be based on what you say, so be thoughtful and strategic while presenting your skills and experiences.
4. **Research the company thoroughly** before the interview – understanding its culture, values, products, and work environment helps you align your answers better.

ALL THE BEST!!!

Keep practicing consistently — remember, **every interview is a learning process** that helps you grow and improve.

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